



BRIEF

INDUSTRIAL BOOM

Women workers were directly affected by increases in mechanization, which in some cases allowed them to do the same work more efficiently than ever before.

1700

- **1764** James Hargreaves invents the spinning jenny, which connects multiple spools to process up to eight threads at once.
- **1769** Richard Arkwright patents the water frame, a device to spin yarn, which can be connected to a water-wheel.
- **1776** Matthew Boulton and James Watt produce the first version of their steam engine. Unlike earlier devices, it has a sufficiently smooth motion to drive machinery.
- **1793** Hannah Slater is the first woman to be granted a patent by the US Patent Office for an improved technique of spinning cotton thread.

1800

- **1828** In the first recorded women's strike in American history, 400 women at a cotton factory in Dover, New Hampshire, walk out in protest against strict new rules.
- **1832** First strike for equal pay by 1,500 female textile workers at Peep Green in Yorkshire, UK.
- **1842** Mines and Collieries Act prohibits women in the UK from working underground in mines.
- **1844** Factories Act in the UK restricts women from working more than 12 hours a day.
- **1847** Legislation in the UK restricts the working hours of women and young people in textile mills to 10 hours a day.
- **1888** Clementina Black secures the first resolution for equal pay at the British Trades Union Congress.

1900

- **1903** Women's Trade Union League founded in the US to campaign nationally for better working conditions for women.

◀ **WOMEN WORK IN THE SPOOLING ROOM**
IN A COTTON MILL IN SPAIN, 1898.

